

Sam Rivera

Engineering Manager, Billing Platform

CONTACT

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SKILLS

Leadership & Talent

Engineering management ·
Talent acquisition and development
Team leadership and mentorship

Cross-functional collaboration

Architecture & Engineering

Software architecture design ·
backend engineering ·
TypeScript ·

Continuous integration and delivery

Delivery & Process

Release management ·
Agile and Scrum methodologies

Software development lifecycle

Compliance & Operations

Regulatory compliance oversight
Incident management

SUMMARY

Founding engineer turned Director of Engineering at Meridian Logistics, where I grew the team from just myself to 20+ engineers spanning backend, frontend, QA, DevOps, and release management, and delivered the infrastructure behind Meridian Logistics becoming the first regulated fintech platform in the US. I architected the backend systems and processes the platform is built on, took releases from ad hoc to a structured bi-weekly cadence across 4 engineering teams, and led the engineering and compliance work across a 7-year regulatory build-out. Hands-on with Node.js and TypeScript, and equally comfortable shaping technical strategy with C-suite leadership, I'm targeting Director of Engineering and VP of Engineering roles where team development and delivery excellence are priorities.

EXPERIENCE

Director of Engineering · Meridian Logistics

Apr 2019 -- May 2026

- Built the engineering organization from the ground up, growing from sole backend engineer to a 20+ person team spanning backend, frontend, QA, DevOps, and release management, with full hiring authority and ownership of every career-level and cultural decision.
- Owned scrum and release management across 4 engineering teams — partnering with product and stakeholders to drive standardized sprint and epic planning and a bi-weekly release cadence through regulated milestones including regulatory the platform approval, custody launch, ETH custody, and clearing and settlement approval.
- Led change management and auditor communication across 3 concurrent audits covering backend platform, onboarding, mobile app, and blockchain — managing timelines, drafting responses, conducting the least-privilege access review, and converting findings into prioritized remediation items in the SDLC workflow.
- Served as engineering lead for incident response across backend, DevOps, and release teams on Meridian Logistics's regulatory-regulated platform, owning technical investigation and cross-functional coordination in an environment where platform failures carried direct regulatory risk.
- Designed the TypeScript microservice backend framework and PostgreSQL schemas the platform is built on today — containerizing services with Docker, building GitHub Actions CI/CD pipelines to satisfy regulatory auditability requirements, and authoring the engineering standards and code review processes from scratch as the team scaled from one engineer to 20+.
- Embedded tech debt cleanup as a standing sprint item in the engineering standards and SDLC processes, keeping a codebase that grew from 1 to 20+ engineers stable in a regulatory-regulated environment where shortcuts carried real compliance risk.

Director of Product Development · Vantage Retail

Dec 2017 -- Apr 2019

- Held a dual engineering and product IC role — contributing to software architecture decisions while establishing the QA standards, CI/CD pipelines, and PR annotation practices that governed how the team designed, reviewed, and shipped code.
- Defined product requirements with stakeholders, balancing customer needs, business objectives, and technical constraints.

- Built QA standards and testing protocols integrating Codecov coverage verification, CI/CD pipelines, and Xray scripts linked to Jira stories — raising test coverage from roughly 50% to 100% as part of peer review gates.

Software Engineer, Tooling/Automation Lead · [Harbor Reviews](#)

Aug 2015 -- Dec 2017

- Led automation initiatives and built internal tooling to streamline developer onboarding and integration workflows, cutting onboarding time from over 2 weeks to 3 days.
- Built internal tooling in JavaScript, React.js, HTML, and CSS within an Agile workflow, contributing to automation work that reduced engineer onboarding from over two weeks to three days.

Senior Software Engineer, Frontend/UX Lead · [Nimbus Freight](#)

Aug 2013 -- Dec 2014

- Built the frontend media player and user platform in AngularJS — styled with LessCSS, bundled with Grunt, and backed by a Node.js/Express API handling cloud storage interactions for user media collections.
- Migrated the backend from PHP to a Node.js/MEAN stack.

Senior Software Engineer · [Beacon Labs](#)

Aug 2012 -- Aug 2013

- Managed end-to-end delivery of custom client applications by running weekly stakeholder check-ins, defining requirements, and tracking work velocity in Pivotal Tracker to keep timelines on target.
- Built custom client applications — including accounting and reservation software — in PHP and AngularJS across the full delivery cycle.